BUSINESS & ECONOMY | Entrepreneurship

BLUEPRINT MOONSHOTS: Risk-taking and betting on New India. Insider notes from an industrialist

SANJIV GOENKA *Chairman, RPSG Group*

A RICH LEGACY

The RP-Sanjiv Goenka Group, the Indian multinational conglomerate, will be launching a green energy venture capital fund in the next couple of months. Expanding its portfolio by the day, the company has made successful inroads into power, media, FMCG, BPO, Ayurveda and even sports. Now, chemicals and green energy happen to be its newest areas of exploration.

Sharing his journey at the India Today Conclave, group chairman Sanjiv Goenka said the business legacy and values he inherited gave him the conviction to try out something new each time. "We took a conscious decision a few years ago to move from government intervention-intensive businesses to new-age businesses. And we started this journey by getting into BPO and IT-enabled services, then into FMCG, Ayurveda and sports... So it's completely re-profiling the portfolio that we've had," said the 62-year-old business magnate.

This, according to him, has been largely made possible because the Union government led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi has ensured "ease of doing business" besides instilling a vision among entrepreneurs to "dream big". "The sheer vision, the scale of the repositioning, of reimagining that the prime minister and the home minister bring to the table is unparalleled," added Goenka.

When asked for his advice to young entrepreneurs, Goenka said hitting upon a simple idea was the key to value creation. "It's about ease of living or ease of consuming where the highest value creation happens," he said, adding how his company is looking at Ayurveda and ways to deliver it in a form that's easy to consume and relatable to the consumers. "We've launched Chyawanprash in the form of gummies. The world is familiar with that," he explained. Asked to pick a favourite among his multiple businesses, Goenka had a succinct response: "If you have more than one child, can you choose a favourite?" ■

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